

The hours worked and the salary paid are the same record.

HR, attendance and payroll for India — built as one system, so nobody copies numbers between tools on the 25th of the month.

[Time & attendance](#)[Payroll](#)[Statutory filing](#)[Core HR](#)[Hiring](#)

Most companies run this on five tools and a spreadsheet

And the join between them is a person, once a month, under time pressure.

A typical setup looks like this. A biometric machine or a tracking tool records who worked. An HR system holds leave. A spreadsheet holds salary structures. A payroll tool computes the pay. An accountant re-types the totals into Tally. Five places, and nothing checks that they agree.

The failure is always the same shape. Somebody exports a file on the 25th, the columns have shifted, or a mid-month joiner is missed, or a leave approval never reached payroll. It is found in the following month, if it is found at all — and by then the money has moved.

Who this is for. Companies of roughly 10 to 500 people in India who run monthly payroll and have to file provident fund, employee insurance, professional tax and income-tax returns. It suits organisations with shift work, field staff or remote teams particularly well, because those are the cases where attendance is hardest to establish.

The whole product, in six steps

This is everything in order. Each section of this guide is a detailed look at one of these six.

1

Work is recorded

A desktop app, a phone, a biometric machine on the wall, or a browser add-on. Whichever a company uses, it arrives in the same place.

2

It becomes attendance

Recorded work is measured against the shift the person was meant to work, producing present, half day, absent or on leave.

3

Payroll is run

The attendance comes into the run without anyone exporting it. Salary, deductions and taxes are calculated from it.

4

Salary is paid

A bank transfer file is produced in the bank's own format, and every payslip is issued from the same figures.

5

Returns are filed

Provident fund, insurance, professional tax and income-tax documents are generated from that run, ready to upload.

6

Books are updated

The run becomes a double-entry journal for Tally or Zoho Books, so nobody re-types salary figures into the accounts.

The one thing worth understanding

In most products, steps 1 and 3 belong to different systems. That is why a payslip and a timesheet can disagree, and why the answer to "why was I paid this?" is usually a spreadsheet somebody has to dig out. Here they are the same record: the minute recorded in step 1 is the minute the payslip in step 4 is built from, and the return in step 5 is generated from that same payslip. That is the whole design, and everything else follows from it.

The desktop app

Installed on a laptop or desktop. Runs on Windows, macOS and Linux. Used by office, remote and hybrid teams.

Timing the work

Start and stop

A person clicks start when they begin and stop when they finish. The time is saved against a project and task if one is chosen, so hours can later be attributed to client work.

Works offline

If the connection drops, the app keeps recording to disk and uploads when it returns. It saves the moment the person actually clicked, not the moment it reached the server, so hours land in the correct month.

Two timers at once

A second piece of work can be timed alongside the main one without stopping it — useful where a support task interrupts project work.

Screenshots

Taken automatically while the timer runs, at whatever interval the company sets. Consent is required first — see page 6.

Idle time — the part that decides whether hours are trusted

Idle handling is where most tracking tools quietly overcharge. If someone leaves their desk with the timer running, a naive tool bills the gap.

The timer stops itself

After five minutes with no typing or mouse movement, the timer stops — and it **backdates the stop to the last real activity**, so the idle gap is never counted as work.

The person is told

An email goes out when idle time has stopped a timer, so it is discovered immediately rather than at the end of the month.

A closed laptop cannot leave it running

If the machine sleeps or the app dies, the server closes the timer using the same rule. A sleeping laptop cannot report fifteen hours.

Genuine offline work is not lost

A phone call or reading a document looks like idle time. The company picks one rule: always count it, never count it, or ask the person. Only the person it belongs to can answer — a manager cannot answer for them.

Why the backdating matters. Recording that idle time happened is not the same as billing for it. The system keeps the idle period on the record so it can be seen and questioned, and removes it from the paid hours. Both facts survive.

Phones, wall machines and the browser

Not everyone works at a laptop. Three more ways in, all landing in the same attendance record.

The mobile app — for field staff, drivers and site teams

Punch in from anywhere

Check in and out from an iPhone or Android phone, with the same record as a desk punch.

Geofencing

Draw a circle on a map around an office or site. A punch from outside it is refused or flagged, depending on the setting. A *geofence* is simply a boundary drawn on a map.

Attendance selfie

A photo is taken at the moment of punching, with a map view showing where each one was taken — the practical answer to proxy attendance.

Approvals on the move

Managers approve leave, attendance corrections and overtime from the phone, so a request does not wait for someone to reach a desk.

Biometric machines — the fingerprint and face readers already on the wall

Existing devices from eSSL, ZKTeco, Biomax and Matrix can send punches directly into the system. Nothing is installed on an office PC; the machine posts the punches itself.

Unknown machines are refused

A device must be registered by an administrator before any punch from it is accepted, so nobody can inject fake attendance.

Unclaimed punches are kept

If a machine sends a punch for an ID nobody has claimed, it is stored rather than discarded. When someone claims that ID, the whole history attaches to them.

A device that stops reporting is surfaced

The settings screen shows any machine that used to report and has gone quiet — the failure that otherwise surfaces on payroll day.

Repeats are harmless

A punch is unique on the device, the device user and the timestamp, so a machine re-sending its buffer cannot double-count anybody.

Worth knowing. The machine has to be able to reach the internet. This uses the push protocol (known as ADMS), which those four brands speak. A device that only offers an SDK for a PC to pull data out of, or one sitting on a network with no outbound route, cannot connect.

The browser add-on

A small Chrome extension records which websites were open, so the activity list shows the actual site rather than just "browser". Anything after a question mark in a web address is stripped before anyone can see it, because that is where login links and one-time codes hide — and it is stripped when the record is displayed, so it also protects records captured before that rule existed.

Monitoring people can live with

Under India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, the responsibility for collecting employee data lawfully sits with the employer — not with the software supplier. So the controls are built in rather than left to you.

How consent works here

One gate, every path

Screenshots, activity, web addresses and location all pass through the same consent check. There is no path that captures first and asks later.

Notices are versioned, never edited

What somebody agreed to is the text they were actually shown. Editing a notice in place would rewrite consent already given, so a change creates a new version.

Attendance is never blocked over privacy

Someone who has not consented to location can still punch in. Only the location is left off. Nobody is marked absent because of a privacy setting.

Who can see a capture

A manager sees their own team only

Never a colleague at their own level, and never anyone senior to them.

Deleting evidence deducts the time

Where a company lets people delete their own screenshots, the tracked time that screenshot covered is deducted with it. Otherwise deleting the proof while keeping the pay would be possible.

Consent is per type, not one blanket tick

Agreeing to activity tracking is not agreeing to screenshots. Each kind of capture is consented to separately.

It can be withdrawn

Withdrawal takes effect on the next capture attempt, which is then refused. The code path ends — the data is not captured and hidden.

Screenshots are purged on a schedule

Kept for the retention period the company sets, then removed automatically.

A screenshot link cannot be forwarded

The link stops working for anyone but the person it was issued to, so a capture cannot be passed around.

Break time is never work time

Break types are configured by the company as paid or unpaid, with a daily limit if wanted, and are excluded from worked hours.

The practical argument for employees. Monitoring is easier to accept when the rules are visible and the time is honest. Idle time is removed rather than billed, breaks are excluded, sensitive parts of web addresses are stripped, and captures expire. Those are the terms, and they are the same for everybody.

Turning recorded hours into a day

Attendance is what payroll actually reads. It is recorded work measured against what the person was supposed to work.

Automatic check-in

Someone who forgets to press check in is marked present the moment they start working, rather than losing the day to a missed click.

Several punches a day

The day is made of separate punch pairs which add up to the total, so lunch, site visits and split shifts are handled properly.

Calendar and register

A month at a glance per person, and a summary across any date range up to 90 days.

Late-mark threshold

The company sets the cut-off. Arriving early records zero minutes late — never credit that could offset a later lateness.

Live view

One screen showing who is in, who is out, who is on leave and who is finishing soon.

Timezone-aware

Times are shown in each person's own zone, with the zone named — so a 9am start in Manila does not appear as 5:30am to someone in Mumbai.

Corrections — when tracking missed real work

This is called **regularisation**. The person asks for time to be added, giving a reason.

Bounded and evidenced

Between ten minutes and ten hours, with a note, and only one open request per day. Checked against the company holiday list.

Forwarding to the right approver

An approver who is not the right person can pass it up the chain or to a named colleague. The full history of who passed it where is kept.

Closed months stay closed

Once payroll for a month is complete, a correction for that month is refused with a clear message rather than quietly changing a figure that was already paid.

Everything lands in one inbox

Leave, corrections, expenses, resignations, offers and payroll approvals all queue in a single approval inbox rather than four separate screens.

Shifts and the rota

For any company where people do not all work nine to five.

Defining a shift

The shift itself

Name, timing, length, unpaid break, and how many minutes of lateness are allowed before it counts.

Overtime follows the shift

Someone on a six-hour shift earns overtime after six hours, not after eight.

Building the rota

Rotations in days, not weeks

Set up a cycle such as four days on, four days off. Each person can start at a different point in the cycle, so the whole team does not rest on the same day.

A day off is recorded, not absent

"Told to take the day off" and "nobody scheduled them" stay different facts — which matters when someone asks why they were marked absent.

Regenerating never destroys a decision

Days a manager set by hand are skipped and reported back, so rebuilding a month does not wipe the person moved to nights on the 14th.

Night shifts detect themselves

A 10pm to 6am shift is treated as a night shift whether or not anyone ticked a box, because the night allowance depends on it.

Timezone-aware resolution

A shift is resolved in the employee's own timezone, which matters the moment a company has people in more than one city or country.

Next month is a draft until published

A manager builds it without changing what attendance expects of anybody today. Attendance ignores drafts entirely.

Past rotas are never rewritten

Last month's rota stays as the record every attendance day was measured against.

Swaps need three people

The person asking, the colleague accepting, and a manager approving. Shifts are re-read at approval rather than trusted from when the request was made, so two people cannot quietly rewrite the site's cover.

Worth knowing. The rota is built through forms rather than by dragging shifts around a calendar. Everything can be set — a one-off day is a form, not a drag.

Leave

The part employees interact with most, and the part where a wrong balance causes the loudest arguments.

Asking for leave

The request

A date range, full day or half day, a leave type and a reason.

Checked before it is submitted

Weekends are excluded, half days count as half, and a request beyond the balance is refused — telling the person exactly how much they have and how much they asked for.

Overlaps are caught

Nobody can accidentally book the same days twice.

Cancellation

Allowed up to one day before it starts. Approving the cancellation removes the absent days — but only days where nobody actually worked, so real work is never deleted.

How balances are built

Each type has its own rules

Its own yearly quota, whether it is paid, and how it accrues — yearly, half-yearly, quarterly or monthly, whichever the company uses.

Fair for mid-year joiners

Somebody joining in August gets a proportionate part-year amount rather than the full year, with a separate rate during probation and during notice period.

A balance is a ledger, not a number

It is the sum of dated entries. So "why is my balance 8.5?" opens into the rows that produced it, instead of ending in an argument.

Year-end, said properly

Carry forward up to a cap with the rest lapsing, reset to zero, or pay it out. Each is recorded as its own entry, so "10 carried, 5 lapsed" is a sentence the system can actually say.

Encashment reaches payroll

Days converted to money at the correct daily rate, checked against the balance and paid through the run rather than added by hand.

Holiday calendars

Per company and per location, applied to both attendance and leave, so a regional holiday is not counted as leave.

Why the ledger matters. A stored counter can only tell you what it currently says. A ledger can tell you how it got there — which accrual added days, which request took them, and what happened at year end. Every balance in this product is the second kind.

Working-time policies and the law

The rules that decide what an hour is worth. Set once for the company, and adjustable for an individual without creating a whole new policy.

Overtime — you decide what it is worth

There is no fixed multiplier, because no two companies pay overtime the same way. You set the rate yourself, once, in the working-time settings. Payroll then applies what you set — nobody re-enters a rate each month.

A separate rate per kind of day

A normal working day, a weekly off and a public holiday are three independent settings, each with its own rate. Paying one rate midweek and a higher one on a holiday is the normal case, not an exception.

Higher rates once it builds up

A second, higher rate can start once overtime passes a threshold — and a rate can be given a validity window, for a seasonal arrangement.

When it starts counting

You set how much overtime must build up before any of it accrues, and whether it is measured on gross hours or on hours net of breaks.

Rounding and approval

How it rounds, and whether a manager must approve it before it reaches payroll. With approval on, unapproved overtime never becomes pay.

The other policies

Weekly off

Fixed or rotating weekly offs, and alternate Saturdays.

Late marks and penalties

What happens after repeated late arrivals or early departures, including half-day rules and how much lateness is tolerated first.

Shift allowances

Night-shift and other allowances, worked out from actual attendance and paid through payroll rather than added manually.

Employees can read their own

So "why was I marked half day" has an answer the person can look up themselves.

Indian working-hour law, checked rather than assumed

Limits belong to the premises

Daily and weekly hour ceilings, spread-over limits and rest breaks come from the Factories Act and the relevant state Shops & Establishments Act, held against the registered establishment and its type — not from a policy somebody typed in.

A separate legal overtime figure

Overtime against the legal threshold — beyond nine hours a day or forty-eight a week — is a different number from overtime against the rostered shift, and it is the one an inspector asks for.

A rate below the legal floor is flagged

If the rate you configured falls below the statutory minimum, it is reported — without silently overwriting the rate you chose.

Unassessed is not the same as compliant

Where an establishment has not been assessed, the report says unassessed rather than showing a green tick that means nothing.

The monthly run

The hours from step 1 and the attendance from step 2 arrive here without anyone exporting or re-typing anything. This is the part most companies do in a spreadsheet.

Processing

Everyone at once

Pick the month, and every employee with a salary set is calculated. Anyone without one is skipped and listed back to you by name, rather than silently left out of payroll.

Or one person

Useful for a late joiner or a correction, without touching anybody else.

Attendance sync

Attendance, leave, unpaid days and overtime come into the run in one action, through a single step you can inspect before trusting it.

Progress you can watch

A large payroll processes in the background with a progress count of done, failed and skipped, rather than a frozen screen.

It cannot run twice

A second attempt while one is already running is refused, so nobody is paid twice by a double click.

Undo one person

A single employee's pay can be reversed and recalculated. Any loan instalment it collected is added back to their loan balance automatically.

The stages a run moves through

STAGE	WHAT IT MEANS
Draft	Figures are being calculated and can still be changed freely.
Locked	The numbers are settled and no longer editable, pending review.
Approved	Signed off. Only now can the bank transfer file be produced.
Released	Payslips are issued to employees.
Disbursed	The money has moved. The month is closed and becomes the permanent record of what was paid.

Separation of duties. The person who locks a run cannot approve it, and the person who approves cannot release it. This switches on automatically once a company has three or more administrators — small teams are not blocked by a rule they cannot satisfy. Every stage records who did it and when, and unlocking a run requires a written reason that is attached to it permanently.

Finding the mistake before the money moves

A payroll error is cheap to fix before disbursement and expensive afterwards. These are the checks that sit in between.

The pre-payroll checklist

A single screen with live counts — "18 of 20 employees have attendance finalised" — covering leave and attendance, joiners and leavers, bonuses and revisions, reimbursements, holds and arrears.

Joiner and leaver review

Who joined, who left, and any final settlements outstanding — with a decision per person: pay normally, hold the calculation, hold only the payment, or leave out.

Stop-payment flag

Hold one person's pay with a reason, either "do not calculate" or "calculate but do not pay".

The differences report — the single most useful check

It shows every figure that moved between two runs, per person and per component, **with the reason it moved**. A salary that changed because of an approved override reads differently from one that changed for no stated reason, and the second is what you are looking for.

Exception reports

Negative pay

Where deductions exceed earnings, the figure is shown as negative rather than rounded up to zero — so the problem is visible before payday instead of hidden by a tidy number.

Duplicates

Duplicate payments, duplicate bank accounts and duplicate employee records are all flagged.

Negative cost

Employees carrying a negative cost to company, which almost always indicates a structure set up wrongly.

Full audit trail

Every action with who did it, when, and from where. Payroll records cannot be edited or deleted after the fact.

Closing the month. Once salary has gone out, that month cannot be re-processed or edited. It is the record of what was actually paid, and a system that lets you quietly change it is a system whose records mean nothing.

Salary structures, pay groups and exceptions

How a salary is composed, how those rules are applied to many people at once, and what happens when one person needs to be different.

The structure

Components

Basic and house rent allowance as percentages, plus fixed amounts for conveyance, meals, internet, transport, uniform, education, books and fuel. Your own components can be added.

Formula components

For anything unusual — a bonus that only applies above a salary threshold, for instance. Formulas are validated before they can be saved.

See it before you assign it

Type any cost to company and see the full monthly breakdown it would produce, before it is given to anybody. *Cost to company, or CTC, is the total annual cost of employing someone.*

Range bands

A junior and a senior on the same template still get appropriate splits, rather than one template per grade.

Pay groups — the first thing to set up

A pay group holds everyone paid the same way, so settings are made once rather than per person. Name, short code, pay frequency and pay day; then provident fund, insurance, professional tax, labour welfare fund and income tax switched on or off for the whole group — and the change flows down to every employee in it automatically.

State-wise registrations

Each group holds its own professional tax establishment number, labour welfare fund number, provident fund registration and insurance registration, recorded per state. This is what makes returns correct for a company operating in more than one state.

One group at a time, with history

A person belongs to exactly one group. Moving them closes the previous membership with an end date rather than overwriting it, so you can always see which group somebody was in when a past month was paid.

Changing one person's salary

You are shown the true cost first

Raising basic pay by ₹1 takes about ₹1.67 out of the balancing allowance, because house rent allowance, employer provident fund and the gratuity provision all move with it. You see that before you save, not after.

Refused at entry, with the number that would work

A value that cannot balance is rejected as you type it, and the message names the largest amount that would work — rather than being accepted and failing on payroll day.

Proposed by one, approved by another

Nobody can approve a change to their own pay. Every change keeps both what was applied and what the system would have calculated, so the difference can always be explained.

In bulk, through a spreadsheet

Export, edit in Excel, upload back. Errors are reported per row with the spreadsheet row number, what is wrong and how to fix it — and nothing is saved until they are cleared.

Statutory deductions, in plain terms

These are the deductions Indian law requires. They are calculated inside the payroll run, not worked out separately and pasted in.

- PF** Provident Fund — a retirement savings scheme. Both the employee and the employer contribute.
- EPS** Employees' Pension Scheme — the pension portion carved out of the employer's provident fund contribution.
- ESI** Employees' State Insurance — state medical insurance for lower-paid employees.
- PT** Professional Tax — a tax charged by individual state governments, not by the central government.
- TDS** Tax Deducted at Source — income tax collected from salary each month rather than in a lump sum.
- LWF** Labour Welfare Fund — a small state-level contribution for worker welfare.
- LOP** Loss of Pay — salary deducted for unpaid absence.

DEDUCTION	WHAT IS HANDLED
Provident fund	The ₹15,000 wage ceiling, 12% from the employee and 12% from the employer, the employer's half split correctly between pension and provident fund, contribution above the ceiling where a company chooses it, and voluntary contributions.
State insurance	The ₹21,000 threshold, at 0.75% from the employee and 3.25% from the employer. Coverage is held for the whole contribution period — April to September, and October to March — so somebody who gets a raise mid-period keeps contributing until it ends. This is the rule most systems get wrong, and it makes the return disagree with the payslip.
Professional tax	All 37 states and union territories. 20 charge it; 17 correctly charge nothing rather than defaulting to a neighbouring state's rate. Special cases are handled, such as Maharashtra's higher February deduction.
Income tax	Old and new regimes, current slabs, surcharge, cess and rebate. Calculated on the year to date, so a mid-year salary change corrects itself across the remaining months instead of arriving as a shock in March.
Gratuity	Provisioned monthly. At settlement, both the five-year qualifying rule and the ₹20,00,000 ceiling are applied.
Labour welfare fund	State by state, on each state's own contribution cycle.
Unpaid leave	Divided by calendar days, so one absent day costs at most one thirtieth of the month — never one twenty-second. Provident fund, insurance and professional tax are then charged on what was actually earned.

When the rules change. Rates and slabs are stored by period rather than built into the software. Re-running an old month applies that month's rules, not today's — which is what makes a recalculation of a past period trustworthy.

Getting the money out, and the returns in

Paying people

The bank file

Produced in your bank's own format for NEFT or RTGS transfer, with names, account numbers, IFSC codes, amounts and a total. Only available once the run has been approved.

Nobody is silently dropped

Anyone who cannot be paid is excluded from the file and returned to you **by name, with the exact detail that is missing**, so they can be paid another way.

The bank's reference is kept

The UTR the bank returns is recorded against the payment, so a line on a bank statement can be matched to a payslip. Where no reference exists the field is left empty rather than filled with an invented code.

Reversals and off-cycle payments

A payment made outside the bank run can be recorded with its own reference. A reversal requires an administrator and a written reason.

Payslips

Issued automatically

Every employee gets a notification and an email with the PDF attached the moment the run is paid. Anyone who already has one is skipped rather than sent a duplicate.

Full history

Every payslip they have ever had, with earnings, each deduction, days worked, hours and running year-to-date totals. An employee can only ever open their own.

Statutory returns

Twenty-three statutory documents are generated from the run: provident fund ECR, insurance challan, Form 24Q, professional tax and labour welfare fund returns, bonus registers, Form 16, Form 12BA and more — formatted for upload to the department portal.

Validated before they are produced

PAN, TAN and UAN numbers are checked first. A document reports as not ready rather than being produced containing an invalid number that the portal will reject.

Per legal entity

Each registered entity has its own PAN, TAN, provident fund and insurance numbers, and returns are produced separately for each.

A compliance calendar

Provident fund and insurance by the 15th, professional tax by the 20th, tax deducted at source by the 7th — with a countdown and a warning as a deadline approaches.

Evidence is recorded

Filing and acknowledgement are separate facts, and the portal's receipt is attached to the filing rather than left in somebody's email.

Worth knowing. Of the 23 documents, **16 are returns** and **7 are preparation sheets** — worklists that help you complete a filing rather than the filing itself. And nothing submits automatically: every document is produced ready, and a person uploads it to the department portal.

Updating the books

The payroll run becomes a double-entry journal for Tally or Zoho Books. Debits must equal credits exactly, and a component with no ledger account assigned **stops the export and is named** — never quietly dropped or dumped into a suspense account, because "the journal is ₹40,000 light and nobody knows why" is what that produces.

Worth knowing. This produces a file you import into Tally or Zoho. It does not connect to them directly over an interface.

Employee records, joining and leaving

The record itself

What it holds

Personal details, address, emergency contact, job details, department, designation, reporting manager, joining date and employment status.

Sensitive data is masked

A list shows whether a PAN is on file, not the number itself. Bank account numbers are masked to the last four digits.

The reporting line is validated

A reporting loop is refused, and a manager must actually be senior to the person reporting to them.

Statutory identifiers

PAN, Aadhaar, UAN, insurance number and bank details, each with its proof document attached. Numbers are format-checked on save, so a wrong PAN is refused at entry rather than discovered on filing day.

Documents are private by default

An offer letter and a warning letter sit on the same record, so sharing is always a deliberate choice. Anything the employee uploaded themselves is always visible to them.

An org chart everyone can see

Who reports to whom, with no salary, no identifier numbers and no personal details in it.

Joining

Hiring someone opens an onboarding journey automatically, however they were added. It is an eighteen-step checklist running from two weeks before the start date to three months after, because several things need doing before somebody arrives.

Every task has an owner

HR, IT, finance, the manager, a buddy, or the joiner themselves — so nothing sits unassigned. The joiner sees only their own items; "IT has not ordered your laptop" is not their problem.

Pre-boarding is normal

A future joining date is valid, not an error, so preparation can start before day one.

Steps complete themselves from evidence

Upload the PAN card and "add PAN details" completes itself. It cannot be ticked by hand, because a hand-ticked box would claim a document exists that payroll will later find missing.

Payroll readiness is checked

Before the first salary run, so a new joiner is never missed or paid wrongly.

Leaving

Resignation

Raised by the employee, with the notice period calculated, manager and HR approval, and the option to withdraw.

Exit and clearance

Clearance checklist, access removal, last working day and an exit interview. Terminations and retirements follow the same route.

Full and final settlement

Notice shortfall recovery, leave encashment, gratuity, part-month salary and any outstanding loan — worked out together and paid as one settlement.

Rehire eligibility

Recorded at exit and surfaced if that person is ever considered again.

What employees do for themselves

Work that would otherwise land on HR as email. Each of these is available on the web and on the phone.

Payslips and the CTC breakup

Current and past payslips, plus the full explanation of what makes up their cost to company.

Attendance corrections

Raise a regularisation for a missed punch rather than emailing HR about it.

Expense claims

Submitted with a receipt photograph taken on the phone.

Salary revision letters

Formally accepted or rejected by the employee, on record — so a revision is agreed rather than announced.

Income tax help, built in

Choosing between India's old and new tax regimes is the question employees ask HR most, and it is a question about their own numbers.

Old regime or new — which is better

Compared side by side on the person's real salary, showing the rupee difference and which to choose.

House rent allowance calculator

Enter the rent paid and see the exemption and the tax it saves.

Leave

Apply, cancel, and see the balance — including the dated entries behind it.

Investment declarations and proofs

Submit declarations and upload the supporting documents for tax purposes.

Profile updates

Address, phone, bank details and documents. Their own submissions are always marked pending review — nobody is their own verifier.

Their own working-time policy

They can read the rules being applied to them, so "why was I marked half day" is self-answerable.

Tax-saving recommendations

Remaining room under Section 80C, the pension scheme, health insurance and home loan interest — each showing the tax it would actually save, largest first.

For the payroll team

Move a group of employees between regimes in one action, approve many proofs at once, and produce Form 12BB from what was approved.

Reimbursements, loans and benefits

Everything that reaches an employee's bank account that is not their basic monthly salary — all of it settled through the payroll run rather than paid separately and reconciled later.

Reimbursements

Submitted with a receipt, approved first by the manager and then by finance, and paid with the next salary. Nobody approves their own — a manager's own claim goes straight to the administrator queue.

Bulk approval

With unread counts, search, and approve or reject in bulk, so a month of claims is not fifty separate clicks.

Loans and salary advances

Requested with an amount and a number of instalments up to sixty. Once approved, instalments are recovered from salary automatically and the loan closes itself when fully repaid.

Recovery survives a correction

If a payslip is reversed, the instalment it collected is added back to the loan balance — so a correction cannot quietly make somebody repay twice.

Flexible benefit plan

Employees choose components within an allowance, claim against proofs, and the tax effect is applied through payroll.

Leave encashment

Days converted to money at the correct daily rate, checked against the balance and paid through the run.

Arrears — back-dated increases done properly

When a raise is agreed in June but effective from April, the difference has to be paid for April and May. This is where spreadsheets usually approximate.

How it is calculated. The difference is worked out against the salary that was *actually in force on each affected day*, not against today's salary applied backwards. A mid-month revision blends correctly. And the tax on the arrear is the difference between the old and the new position — not a fresh charge on the whole amount, which would over-deduct.

Variable pay

Bonus and incentive rules are set once and applied per person through the run, so a performance payment arrives on the payslip with its own line rather than being added to salary and losing its identity.

Everything around the edges

Hiring

A candidate is a person; an application is one attempt

So somebody good who applies for a second role keeps their history instead of becoming a duplicate record.

Panel feedback is never averaged

Recorded per interviewer. Three people split two-to-one and three people all lukewarm produce the same average but call for completely different conversations.

Background checks are consent-gated

Consent is recorded against a specific list of checks: agreeing to employment verification is not agreeing to a credit check. Findings are recorded as clear, discrepancy or insufficient — never pass or fail.

Your own pipeline stages

Every move recorded and dated. Moving somebody backwards is allowed and recorded as such, and "rejected after the technical round" stays a different fact from "rejected on the CV".

Offers, approved then signed

An approval chain before it goes out, then the candidate opens a secure link, reads the letter, types their name and accepts or declines. No account to create — asking a candidate to register loses offers.

Straight into onboarding

Accepting an offer moves the candidate through the pipeline to hired, so headcount and the offer cannot disagree, and joining formalities begin immediately.

Worth knowing. There is no public careers page — candidates are added by your hiring team rather than applying themselves. Background check findings are recorded by a person; there is no connection to a verification agency.

Reports

Time and productivity

Hours by person, team and project; productive against unproductive time; which applications and websites were used.

Attendance

Present, absent, late, early leaving and overtime across any period.

Payroll registers

The full salary register for a month, plus separate provident fund, insurance, professional tax and income tax registers.

Headcount movement

Joiners, leavers and running headcount month by month, counted properly — including people who have since left.

Attrition

Who left, when, why, and from which department.

Export

Any report to Excel.

Asking questions, and the work around the work

Ask a question in plain English

Most reporting questions are asked once and never again, which makes building a report for them a waste.

"Who was absent more than three days last month". "Average salary by department". "Top five departments by salary cost in July". Each is answered as a table from your own records, without anybody building a report first.

Every answer shows its working

How the figure was arrived at, what period it covers and how many records it used — so it can be checked rather than taken on faith.

It says no rather than guessing

A question it cannot answer is refused with the reason. And an empty result is reported as empty, never as zero — those are different facts, and confusing them is how a report quietly misleads.

Day-to-day work

Projects and tasks

Owners, due dates, priorities, checklists, dependencies and comments, with time logged against each — so hours can be attributed to a deliverable rather than to a day. Recurring tasks create themselves on a schedule.

Chat

One-to-one and group messaging with file sharing, including large files, inside the workspace rather than on a separate app.

Assets

Laptops, phones and equipment assigned to people, with return tracked as part of the exit checklist rather than remembered separately.

Performance

Review cycles, goals with progress check-ins, a competency framework, and feedback gathered from self, manager and peers.

Polls

Ask the whole company a question and see the answers.

One approval inbox

Leave, attendance corrections, expenses, resignations, offers and payroll — everything waiting on a person, in one place instead of six screens.

Notifications arrive as they happen. Approvals, payroll events and messages are delivered in real time rather than on a timer, so an approval that unblocks somebody does not sit unseen. The chat page itself still refreshes on a short interval — it works well, but it is not a live chat application.

The four apps

Web

The full system — payroll, attendance, people, hiring, reports and settings. Used by HR, finance, managers and administrators.

Desktop

Windows, macOS and Linux. Time tracking, screenshots, idle detection, and works offline.

Mobile

iPhone and Android. Punch in and out, apply for leave, see payslips, approve requests, attendance selfie and notifications.

Browser add-on

Chrome. Records which websites were used so activity reports show real detail.

Who can see what, and how it is protected

Salary is the most sensitive thing a company holds. In most small companies it sits in a spreadsheet that anyone with the file can open.

LEVEL	WHAT THEY CAN REACH
Admin	Everything — settings, all employees, all salary, all reports, and who else gets which role.
HR / Payroll	Runs payroll and sees everybody's pay, but cannot change company settings or hand out roles. <i>This is the level most products do not have, which is why HR usually ends up as a full administrator.</i>
Manager	Their own team only — attendance, leave, timesheets, approvals. They cannot see company salary data.
Employee	Their own record, payslips and leave, plus the org chart, which carries no salary or personal details.

"My team" really means my team

A manager can only act on someone both below them and in their department. Level alone would let any manager reach any employee; department alone would let them act on their own department head.

Nobody locks the company out

Only an administrator changes roles, and an administrator cannot remove their own administrator rights.

Protecting the data

One company cannot see another

Separation is enforced in the data layer itself rather than by remembering to filter, with an automatic test that fails the build if a new record type is added without it.

Company sign-in

Staff can sign in with the company's existing Microsoft or Google account. Turning it on is a deliberate second step, because it changes how everyone signs in.

Audit log

Every meaningful action with the person, the time and what changed. Payroll records cannot be edited or deleted after the fact.

Custom roles

Create roles with your own names — "Shift Supervisor", "Regional HR" — choosing from around thirty separate permissions.

Approvals follow the hierarchy

An approver must be senior to the person asking, and nobody approves their own request.

Two-factor authentication

Authenticator codes with backup codes. Optional, on a grace period, or required — and required automatically for senior roles.

Removing someone removes their access

Where the company directory is connected, deactivating a person revokes their existing access tokens rather than just marking them inactive — the failure that otherwise leaves a leaver reading payroll on Monday.

Temporary elevated access

Where somebody genuinely needs more, it is a time-limited session with a written reason, not a permission quietly granted for ever.

Being straight about this. There is no ISO 27001 certificate or SOC 2 report at present, and no published uptime guarantee. The controls above are built and can be demonstrated; the external audit has not been done. If your procurement process requires one of those, you should know it here rather than in week three of an evaluation.

See it on your own numbers. The fastest way to judge a payroll engine is to run a month through it in parallel with your current one and compare the differences report line by line. That is a conversation we are happy to start with.